

STIMPSON
REALTY
Rooted in Relationships

THE ULTIMATE GUIDE TO *Buying* A HOME

BUYER'S GUIDE



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YOUR REAL ESTATE EXPERT



Zach Stimpson

REALTOR®

Being raised in North Carolina and being heavily involved in motorsports, I have developed a passion for going fast and winning. I enjoy competition, whether it's on the track or at the negotiation table, and take pride in getting things done, regardless of the location. I moved to Idaho in 2018 to pursue an opportunity for growth inside the real estate industry... I ended up falling in love with not only the state, but the lady who would turn into my wife as well. I have always been an enthusiast of the great outdoors and feel the expanse of what this area has to offer is unrivaled by way of both the people and the landscape. This has allowed me to expand upon my passion for financial freedom and develop an even greater passion for real estate and serving the folks of East Idaho. I absolutely love being able to create opportunities for people through homeownership and real estate. I truly believe there is nothing more impactful to one's financial freedom journey than real estate, if navigated properly. It would be a pleasure to guide you down that path.

Let's Connect

704-775-3208

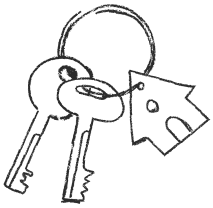
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THE HOME BUYING PROCESS



- MEET WITH YOUR AGENT
- GET PRE-APPROVED
- FIND YOUR HOME
- MAKE AN OFFER
- ORDER INSPECTION & APPRAISAL
- PREPARE FOR CLOSING
- GET YOUR KEYS!

From first meeting to keys

Each purchase is different, but these are the major milestones you can expect.

01 **Set goals + budget**

02 **Talk with lenders**

03 **Tour and compare homes**

04 **Write + negotiate an offer**

05 **Deposit earnest money**

06 **Inspections + due diligence**

07 **Appraisal + loan underwriting**

08 **Final walk-through + signing**

Your purchase contract controls the actual dates. Put every deadline on your calendar and confirm who is responsible for each step.

PREPARING TO BUY

- *Determine* HOW MUCH YOU CAN SPEND
- *Save* FOR A DOWN PAYMENT
- *Check* YOUR CREDIT
- *Get Pre-Approved* FOR A HOME LOAN



What does buying really cost?

The down payment is only one piece. Plan for the cash you may need before, during, and after closing.

01

Down payment

Depends on loan program and your financing plan.

02

Earnest money

Deposit submitted under the contract; typically credited at closing.

03

Inspection + appraisal

Often paid before closing, depending on the transaction.

04

Closing costs + prepaids

Lender/title fees, prepaid insurance, taxes and escrow funding.

05

Move-in reserve

Moving, repairs, utilities, furnishings, and unexpected expenses.

THE PRACTICAL RULE

Do not plan to use every available dollar at closing. Keep a cushion for life after the keys.



HOMEOWNERSHIP MAY BE CLOSER THAN YOU THINK

Your down payment is not one-size-fits-all.

Three ways to think about the upfront funds on a $350,000 home.

IDAHO HOUSING DPA

$500

Potential buyer contribution with eligible assistance

Bar scale: $0 to $70,000

3.5% DOWN

$12,250

3.5% of purchase price before assistance

Bar scale: $0 to $70,000

20% DOWN

$70,000

20% of purchase price before closing costs

Bar scale: $0 to $70,000

ABOUT IDAHO HOUSING ASSISTANCE

Eligible buyers may qualify for help with a down payment and closing costs.

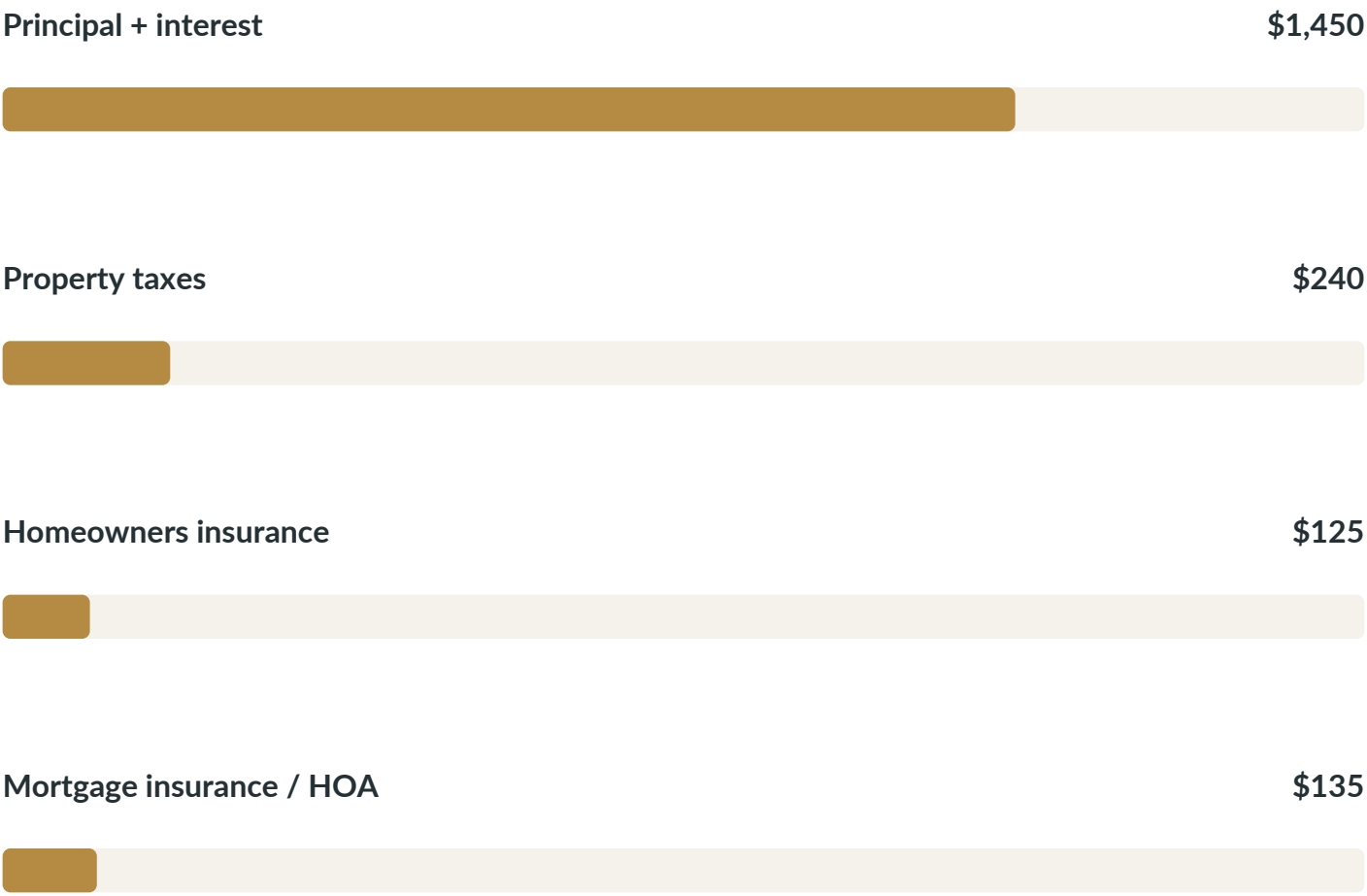
The $500 example is a potential minimum buyer contribution, not a $500 down payment.

Assistance may be financed through an additional mortgage; terms and eligibility vary.

Ask your lender to compare total cash to close, monthly payments, and program options.

Your payment is more than a rate

Ask your lender for a full estimated monthly housing payment, not just principal and interest.



EXAMPLE TOTAL

$1,950 / month

These figures are hypothetical and are not based on a quoted interest rate or specific property. Utilities, maintenance, and repairs are additional ownership expenses.

But first, get pre-approved

House shopping is exciting. A little preparation can make your search more productive.

START WITH A LENDER

Getting pre-approved before you start touring homes helps you understand your budget and puts you in a stronger position to make an offer when you find the right place.



KNOW YOUR NUMBERS. SHOP WITH CONFIDENCE.

Your lender can explain loan options, payments, and cash needed to close.

Pre-qualified vs. pre-approved

Two early financing conversations that serve different purposes.

PRE-QUALIFIED

A lender may estimate what you could borrow based primarily on the information you provide, sometimes without reviewing documents or credit. This is an early estimate, not a loan approval.

PRE-APPROVED

To get preapproved, a lender typically reviews your credit and financial documents. A preapproval letter indicates a potential loan amount, subject to final underwriting and approval.



ASK YOUR LENDER WHAT HAS BEEN VERIFIED

QUESTIONS TO ASK YOUR LENDER

Choosing the right lender

Different lenders offer different loan options, rates, and fees. These questions can help you compare your choices with confidence.

01 Which types of home loans do you offer?

02 What is my interest rate and annual percentage rate (APR)?

03 Do I qualify for any special programs or discounts?

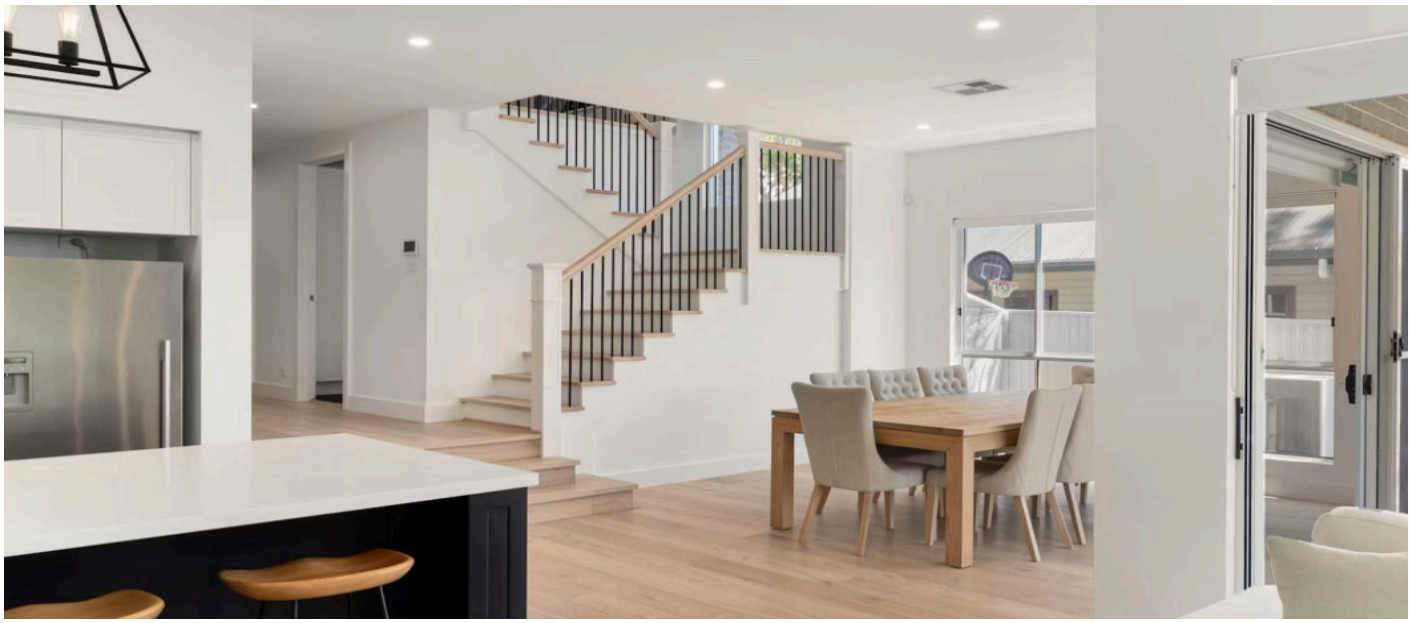
04 What are the estimated closing costs I should expect to pay?

05 What is your average loan processing time?



More than opening doors

Your agent helps you make informed decisions, manage details, and negotiate with confidence.



01 UNDERSTAND THE MARKET

Compare recent sales, pricing, and property condition before making a decision.

02 PROTECT YOUR PRIORITIES

Discuss contract terms, deadlines, contingencies, and possible tradeoffs.

03 COORDINATE THE PROCESS

Keep the lender, title company, inspectors, and other parties moving together.

04 NEGOTIATE STRATEGICALLY

Consider price, repairs, credits, timing, and terms that matter to you.

Trusted Lenders

Brandon Rhodehouse - Patriot Home Mortgage



(208) 521-8075
brandon@patriothomemortgage.com
https://patriothomemortgage.com
1970 E 17th St Suite 116, Idaho Falls, ID 83404

Tony Eckman - Premier Mortgage Resources



(208) 390-2256
tony.eckman@pmrloans.com
www.pmrloans.com/teckman
1515 Ashment Ave. Suite 1 Idaho Falls, Idaho 83404

Kabe Call - Idaho First Mortgage



(208) 520-9673
kcall@idahofirstmortgage.com
https://idahofirstmortgage.com/team-directory/kabe-call/

Brandy Knight - Summit Funding Inc.



(208) 569-4085
bknight@summitfunding.net
https://summitfunding.net/bknight
545 Shoup Avenue STE 228 Idaho Falls, ID 83402

Ryan Jensen - Frontier Credit Union



(208) 705-5704
rjensen@frontiercreditunion.com
https://frontiercreditunion.com/loans/home/
3255 E 17th St, Ammon, ID 83406

Your mortgage paperwork

A simple checklist to help you prepare for your loan application.

01 INCOME

- ☐ Federal tax returns: last 2 years
- ☐ W-2s: last 2 years
- ☐ Pay stubs: last 2 months
- ☐ Additional income documentation, if applicable: pension, retirement, child support, Social Security or disability award letters, etc.

02 ASSETS

- ☐ Bank statements: 2 most recent checking and savings account statements
- ☐ 401(k) or retirement account statement and summary
- ☐ Other assets: statements and summaries of IRAs, stocks, bonds, etc.

03 OTHER

- ☐ Copy of driver's license or ID and Social Security card
- ☐ Addresses for the past 2–5 years and landlord's contact info, if applicable
- ☐ Student loan statements showing current and future payment amounts
- ☐ Documents relating to divorce, bankruptcy, collections, judgments, or pending lawsuits, if applicable.

Your lender may request additional documents based on your situation.

Finding Your Dream Home

A little clarity now makes every home tour more productive.

START WITH YOUR WISH LIST

Create a list of what you want.

Determine five make-or-break items that you must have in your home.

> Think needs first, then nice-to-haves.



Look beyond the staging

The best home is not always the one with the prettiest photos. Use your tour to imagine everyday life.



LAYOUT

Can your furniture fit? Does the flow work for everyday life?

CONDITION

Look closely at windows, floors, ceilings, odors, and visible maintenance.

BIG-TICKET ITEMS

Ask about roof age, heating, cooling, water heater, and major updates.

LOCATION

Notice traffic, sunlight, parking, neighboring uses, and travel time.

What matters here

A few regional details deserve extra attention during your search.



WELLS & SEPTIC

For rural properties, understand the system, records, and testing options.

WATER & IRRIGATION

Confirm what water rights or irrigation arrangements actually transfer.

WINTER READINESS

Consider insulation, heating costs, roof drainage, and snow removal.

LAND & ACCESS

Review boundaries, easements, road maintenance, and outbuilding use.

House Wants & Needs

Your priorities, clearly defined.

Use this worksheet to separate essentials from preferences before touring homes.

TYPE OF HOME

☐ Single-family ☐ Townhouse ☐ Condo ☐ Other

CONDITION

☐ Move-in ready ☐ Some work is OK ☐ Fixer-upper

DESIRED FEATURES

Bedrooms: _____ Bathrooms: _____ Garage: _____

Yard size: _____ Approx. square footage: _____

PREFERRED AREA / NEIGHBORHOOD

MUST HAVE

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

WOULD LIKE TO HAVE

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

House Hunting Tips

A smarter way to search

Small details can make a big difference when you are comparing homes.

01 INVESTIGATE THE AREA

Explore neighborhoods, home upkeep, traffic patterns, and nearby amenities.

02 ASK AROUND

Friends, family, and coworkers may know about homes or owners considering a sale.

03 KEEP AN OPEN MIND

Prioritize your must-haves, but stay flexible about details that can change.

04 TAKE PHOTOS & NOTES

Record features and observations during tours so you can compare homes later.

05 BE READY TO MAKE AN OFFER

Discuss your financing and offer strategy ahead of time so you can act confidently.

My home search scorecard

Use the same criteria for each home so your decisions are based on more than memory.

PROPERTY ADDRESS

ASKING PRICE / EST. MONTHLY PAYMENT

TOP THREE THINGS I LOVE

THINGS TO INVESTIGATE

REPAIRS OR UPDATES TO BUDGET

MY OVERALL RATING ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Price is only one lever

A compelling offer is about the complete package: price, certainty, timing, and terms.



01

PURCHASE PRICE

Use recent comparable sales and the home condition to guide your number.

02

EARNEST MONEY

Consider a deposit that fits your budget and the agreed contract terms.

03

CLOSING TIMELINE

Align financing, inspections, possession, and the seller's needs.

04

NEGOTIATED TERMS

Review concessions, included items, repairs, and other conditions.

Negotiations

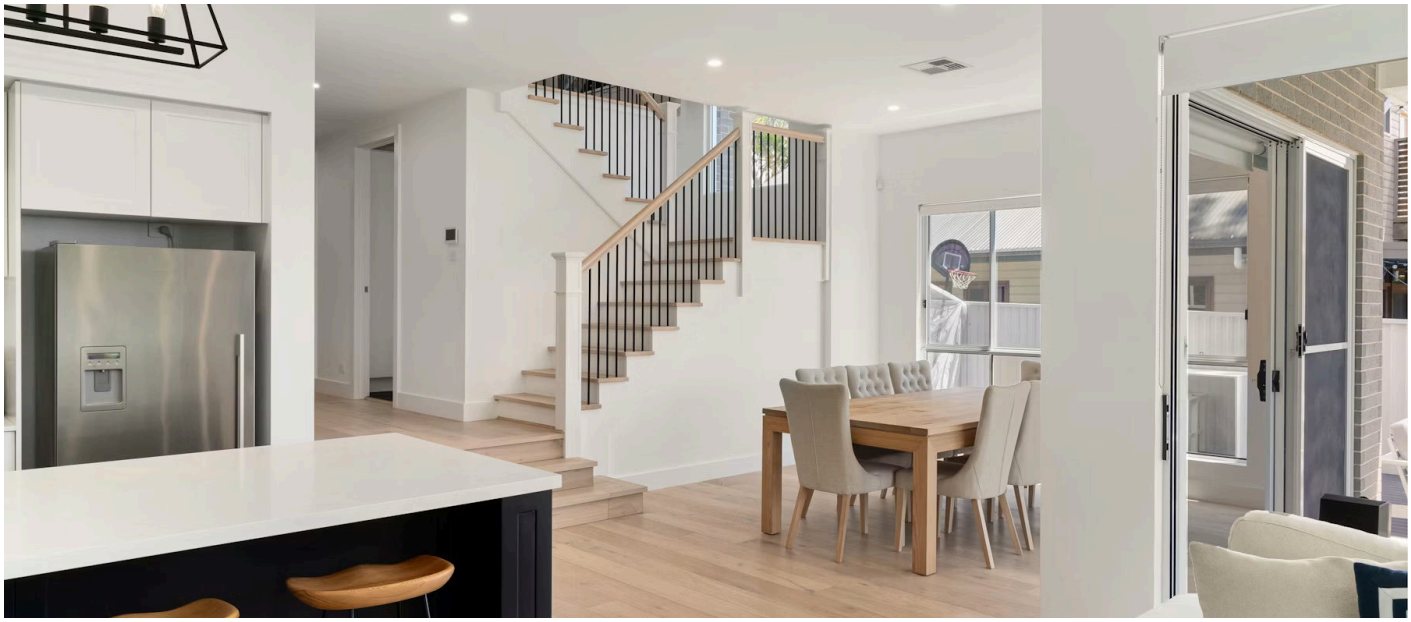
A SELLER CAN ACCEPT YOUR OFFER, REJECT IT, OR MAKE A COUNTEROFFER.

If the seller makes a counteroffer, you can negotiate terms that work for both parties. Offers and counteroffers may go back and forth until you reach an agreement.



Inspection: what comes next?

An inspection helps you better understand the property and plan your next move.



01

SCHEDULE

Book your inspection within the dates established in your contract.

02

REVIEW

Read the report carefully; focus on safety, systems, and expensive repairs.

03

DISCUSS

Talk through findings and possible options with your agent.

04

DECIDE

Determine whether to proceed, request changes, or take another contract-permitted step.

What Not to Do Before Closing

Keep your financing on track through the finish line.

01 BUY OR LEASE A CAR

Avoid taking on a new monthly payment.

02 CHANGE JOBS

Talk with your lender before making employment changes.

03 MISS A BILL PAYMENT

Keep all existing accounts current.

04 OPEN NEW CREDIT

Wait before applying for new cards or loans.

05 MOVE LARGE SUMS OF MONEY

Ask how to document transfers and deposits.

06 MAKE A MAJOR PURCHASE

Hold off on large expenses until after closing.

WHY IT MATTERS

Any of these changes could affect your loan approval. Lenders may recheck your credit or finances before closing.



The Final Stretch

The last week is about confirming details, not starting over.



CONFIRM YOUR NUMBERS

Review final funds and payment instructions with trusted contacts.

PROTECT YOUR FINANCING

Avoid major financial changes until you are clear to close.

COMPLETE THE WALKTHROUGH

Verify property condition and agreed items before signing.

PREPARE FOR SIGNING

Confirm your appointment, identification, and payment method.

Homeowners Insurance

Protecting your investment

Understanding coverage and comparing policies are important parts of buying a home.

WHY IT MATTERS

Homeowners insurance helps protect your home and belongings from covered losses. Mortgage lenders generally require coverage.

WHAT IT MAY COVER

Policies commonly cover certain damage to the home, personal belongings, and personal liability, subject to terms and limits.

WHAT MAY NOT BE COVERED

Flood and earthquake damage typically require separate coverage. Review exclusions and deductibles carefully.

WHAT AFFECTS THE COST

Rates can depend on property characteristics, location, claims history, selected coverage, and deductibles.

WAYS TO SAVE

Ask about discounts for bundling policies and eligible safety features. Compare quotes, coverage, and limits.

Title Insurance

WHAT IS TITLE INSURANCE?

Title insurance protects the lender and/or homeowner from financial loss against claims regarding the legal ownership of a home.

HOW DOES TITLE INSURANCE COVERAGE WORK?

There are two main types of title insurance: a lender's policy and an owner's policy. A lender's policy protects the lender's interest and is commonly required for a mortgage. An owner's title insurance policy can protect the buyer against certain covered title claims and defects.

IS A TITLE SEARCH SUFFICIENT?

A title search reviews ownership records, but it may not uncover every issue. Title insurance provides protection to insured parties against certain covered title problems discovered later.

HOW MUCH DOES TITLE INSURANCE COST?

Title insurance is generally paid as a one-time premium at closing. The cost depends on the specific property, purchase price, policy coverage, insurer, and transaction details. Who pays for the lender's and owner's policies depends on the purchase contract and local practices. Ask your title company for a property-specific quote.



Cleared to Close

Closing is the final step of the buying process. Required documents are signed, funds are disbursed, and ownership is transferred according to the closing process. The buyer and seller may sign at different times.



Success Stories

"Zach is fantastic! Honest, reliable, and 100% committed to ensuring we had the best experience possible! We were facing a stressful cross country move, and Zach was flexible with setting up showings, and really managed everything here so we could focus on getting packed up and moved from the other side of the country. He helped us find our ideal place and went over the top to ensure it all went through without a hitch. Couldn't recommend him more."

Kenny Seaver - Google Review

★★★★★





"Our journey with Zach has been a long one! One that we would not change for any reason, from day one he has had our best interests at heart. He listened to our wants and needs he found them and then some. We were so close a couple of times but our financing wasn't quite there. He never gave up or tried to mislead us in anyway shape or form he was always straight to the point one of the things about Zach that my wife and I really love about Zach is the fact that he talks to you not at you. I mean he never came across as I'm better than you."

Wesley Boyd - Google Review

★★★★★

"Zach is amazing. Zach went above and beyond what my other two realtors did. Zach was willing to work around my husband's weird plumbing work schedule. Zach was willing to go out late or have us call him last minute to see houses. I wouldn't choose anyone else. My kids even liked him."

Breanne Bell - Google Review

★★★★★



Time to get the keys

Your agent and title company will help coordinate the final signing and transfer.



01

BRING IDENTIFICATION

Have an acceptable government-issued photo ID ready for signing.

02

CONFIRM FUNDS

Verify payment instructions by calling a trusted, independently verified number.

03

REVIEW DOCUMENTS

Allow time to read and ask questions about the final paperwork.

04

CELEBRATE

After closing and authorized possession, enjoy your new home.



YOUR NEXT CHAPTER

Starts with a conversation.

Whether you are ready to tour homes or just starting to plan, I would be glad to help you put together a smart next step.

ZACH STIMPSON | STIMPSON REALTY

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